

[Camera starts recording.]

You: "Am I good here?"

Interviewer: "Yeah, that's fine."

(You adjust the chair and glance around.)

You: "Sorry... where should I be looking?"

Interviewer: "Anywhere you're comfortable."

(A few seconds of silence.)

Interviewer: "Want to take a moment before we start?"

(You stare at the floor, thinking.)

You: "...Yeah."

(You take a slow, deep breath. Your hands fidget slightly.)

You: "I didn't think... I'd ever have to talk about this."

(You try to continue but stop. Swallow. Shake your head.)

Interviewer: "Would some water help?"

(You nod. Take the bottle. Drink. Set it down.)

(Another deep breath.)

You: "Thanks."

(A brief pause.)

You: "I've replayed that day in my head more times than I can count."

(Look away for a second.)

You: "The strange part is... none of it should've surprised me."

(Beat.)

You: "He'd been saying things for weeks."

"At first, everyone laughed."

"Then... we got used to hearing it."

"After a while, nobody paid attention anymore."

(Long pause.)

You: "I wish we had."